reach Dimapur, the weather the next morning did not permit any helicopter flying at all, so we ended up going by road to Kohima, to visit IGAR(N). The IG, of course, was happy that I was visiting my old home. This also gave me the opportunity to interact with the Governor, Shri PB Acharya, and the Chief Minister, Shri Neiphiu Rio. Whenever I went to Dimapur, I used to meet as many people as possible. I met up with VS Atem of the NSCN(IM) and Khitovi Zhimomi of the NSCN(KK) to seek their views on the prevailing situation in Nagaland and the talks on the Naga Peace Accord, as well as journalists and members of NGOs such as the Naga Mothers' Association. I made notes of all these meetings as they would be useful for my PhD thesis on 'Harmonizing Naga Customs, Traditions and Institutions in the Context of Peace and Development'.

Following the signing of the Framework Agreement in 2015, there were great expectations that a full-fledged Naga Peace Accord (NPA) would soon follow, bringing to an end this long-running insurgency. However, that had not happened, even though elections for the state legislature held in 2018 had been fought on that promise. Following the Framework Agreement, many more stakeholders had been made part of the negotiations, which had irked the NSCN(IM), as they felt that they were the pre-eminent voice of the people. The IM was still holding out on the core issues of a separate Flag and Constitution, which were no-go as far as the Centre was concerned. On the other hand, the NSCN (KN)[3] was more than willing to sign on the dotted line, though they too had some additional demands, which, however, were not insurmountable. However, it was more prudent to have all the stakeholders on board, and so the negotiations were ongoing. The locals I spoke to, my friends from my earlier tenure, were also of the opinion that the contentious issues could be put on the back burner to

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